

■ **SECURITY**

Android 14 could offer better protection against malware

Google is addressing the problem of malware on Android smartphones by implementing stricter app development and distribution guidelines. They have ensured apps on the Google Play Store are free of malware, but the ability to sideload apps can create a loophole for malware to spread. To address this, Google plans to block the installation of outdated apps on Android 14 as seen in recent code changes. The goal of this move is to eliminate the potential for malware to spread through sideloading and older apps. Google is encouraging Android users to regularly update their applications. As the latest version of Android, Android 13, is only on 5.2 percent of devices, Google may raise the minimum API limit to Android 6.0 to better protect users from malware spread. This is because malware attacks often target older versions of Android with outdated security patches and vulnerabilities. Once Google begins blocking sideloading, the number of malware attacks will decrease significantly. It's worth noting that this will not impact newer smartphones with newer versions of the OS, as they receive timely



updates for their apps. Google is contemplating giving brands the option to toggle the feature that blocks the installation of outdated apps on Android 14. The company acknowledges the problem of malware on

Android phones and is taking steps to address it. To give users full control of their devices, Google may also provide a way for users to bypass the feature through the command shell by introducing a specific flag. It's worth noting that this process would be more complex than just installing an APK. The aim is to make it difficult for most users to bypass the feature, while still providing a way for those who need it. We may see this feature in Android 14, which will be launched in March.

■ **STREAMING**

Indian Anime fans can now stream shows and more on Crunchyroll

Have you found yourself wishing for a streaming service that can let you watch Anime all day long? Well, we've got some great news for you. Crunchyroll is a top-notch streaming service to watch older anime like the original Dragonball series or the latest episodes of Attack on Titan. Keep reading to learn more about the service and its cost below. Crunchyroll is a streaming service for anime fans, similar to Netflix or Amazon Prime. However, Crunchyroll is exclusively focused on anime content. The platform has a wide variety of anime titles available and also allows users to read Japanese manga comics. While



the service has a narrow focus on anime, it is a great choice for fans of the genre as most of the anime they want to watch will probably be available on the platform. Crunchyroll offers a free ad-supported subscription that allows users to watch a large collection of anime in 1080p. For those who want unlimited access to anime

and the ability to watch episodes as soon as they release, the premium subscription may be a better option. In India, the premium subscription starts at Rs 79 per month for the "Fan" tier, which includes an ad-free interface, unlimited access to the service's complete catalogue in the country and access to Crunchyroll's manga collection in English. However, users are restricted to streaming on only one device at a time with this tier. The "Mega Fan" subscription tier offers all the benefits of the "Fan" tier, along with the ability to stream on up to four devices at a time and the ability to view content offline. **d**